0DTE nearest-OTM package: per-rule return summary, entry 13:30 ET, one-bar hold, models compared on the same 866 days

	n	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	t	Sharpe$_{\text{ann}}$	Sharpe$^{\times}_{\text{ann}}$
Short volatility (always short)										
all models (no forecast)	866	0.008	0.161	-1.07	0.25	-2.85	11.71	1.46	0.79	-3.47
sign(s) *(±1 on the sign of s)*										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	866	0.004	0.161	-1.01	1.07	0.21	11.08	0.70	0.38	-4.00
block-diagonal ridge	866	0.008	0.161	-1.01	1.07	-0.25	11.19	1.47	0.80	-3.58
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	866	0.009	0.161	-1.01	1.07	0.14	11.12	1.56	0.84	-3.54
LightGBM†	866	0.001	0.161	-1.07	0.96	-0.34	11.10	0.24	0.13	-4.23
XGBoost†	866	-0.003	0.161	-1.07	0.96	-0.34	11.07	-0.50	-0.27	-4.62
lasso (causally tuned)†	866	0.005	0.161	-1.01	1.07	0.50	11.05	0.96	0.52	-3.86
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	866	0.009	0.161	-1.01	1.07	-0.18	11.21	1.74	0.94	-3.44
elastic net (causally tuned)†	866	0.004	0.161	-1.07	0.96	-0.15	11.12	0.74	0.40	-3.96

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 13:30 ET and exit thirty minutes later at the next stamp, in the same two strikes. 866 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck's frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged. One expiration day = one return; mid fill. Every t here is the plain $t = \sqrt{n} \cdot \text{mean}/\text{std}$, with no autocorrelation correction. "ex. kurt" is the bias-corrected sample excess kurtosis (Gaussian = 0). The short-volatility rule takes no forecast, so it is one row for all models. $\text{Sharpe}_{\text{ann}} = (\text{mean}/\text{std}) \times \sqrt{252}$; every other column is daily. The one column this table adds to the deck's is Sharpe$^{\times}_{\text{ann}}$, the same rule's annualized Sharpe at the *crossed spread* instead of the midpoint; every other column is the deck's.

Forecasts: baseline (HAR + calendar OLS); block-diagonal ridge (HAR block and exogenous block, separate penalties) on the design carrying the FOMC calendar block, and the same ridge on the earlier design without those columns, as a diagnostic row; LightGBM and XGBoost on the all-features design; lasso on the same design, causally tuned vs. fixed $\alpha = 10^{-4}$; elastic net (causally tuned). † marks a column still fitted on the earlier design panel; a run of those four on the panel of record is pending. The signal is $s_t = \widehat{RV}_t - \text{IV}^2_{\text{hr}} h_t w_t$: the forecast against the implied variance of the same window. On the bars whose vendor implied volatility is a censored solver node the deck's treatment is used here too — the volatility that reproduces the package midpoint, recovered by bisection over the remaining h_t hours — so every bar carries a signal and no bar sits flat.